# OBS Studio: Installation and First Recording Guide

**Document type:** Installation and configuration guide

**Audience:** Beginners who want to record their screen

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***Scope note:*** *This guide is an independent writing sample, not official OBS Project documentation. Menu labels and setup steps can vary by operating system and software version. Verify the current installer and interface before publishing this guide as instructions for a specific release.*

## 1. Overview

This guide helps a beginner install OBS Studio, complete the initial setup, make a short test recording, and confirm that the recording works.

## 2. Prerequisites

Before starting, prepare:

- A Windows, macOS, or Linux computer that meets the requirements for the OBS Studio release you plan to install.
- An internet connection.
- Permission to install software on the computer.
- Enough free disk space for the installer and your test recording.
- A microphone or camera only if you want to record audio or video from those devices.

**Important:** Download OBS Studio only from the official website: https://obsproject.com/

## 3. Download and install OBS Studio

1. Open a web browser.
2. Go to the official OBS Studio website: https://obsproject.com/
3. Select the download option for your operating system.
4. Open the downloaded installer.
5. Follow the installer prompts. Review each screen before selecting **Next**, **Install**, or the equivalent control shown by your operating system.
6. When installation finishes, launch OBS Studio.
7. If your operating system asks for permission to access a microphone, camera, or screen, review the request and allow only the access you need.

### Installation checkpoint

Continue when OBS Studio opens and displays its main window. If the installer fails, see [Troubleshooting](#7-troubleshooting).

## 4. Complete the initial setup

OBS Studio versions may offer an automatic configuration wizard on first launch.

1. If the **Auto-Configuration Wizard** appears, read the available options.
2. Choose the option that best matches your goal, such as recording or streaming. For this guide, choose a recording-focused option if one is offered.
3. Follow the wizard prompts and apply its recommended settings.
4. If the wizard does not appear, continue with the default settings and configure a basic recording manually.
5. Find the **Scenes** and **Sources** panels in the main window.

A **scene** is a layout for your recording. A **source** is an item captured in that layout, such as a display, application window, webcam, or audio input.

## 5. Create a basic screen recording

The exact source names and permission prompts differ by operating system.

1. In the **Scenes** panel, select the existing scene or add a new scene.
2. In the **Sources** panel, select **+** (Add).
3. Choose a suitable capture source, such as **Display Capture** or **Window Capture**, if available on your system.
4. Give the source a clear name, then confirm the selection.
5. If prompted, select the display or application window you want to capture.
6. Check the preview. Make sure it shows the intended content and does not reveal private information.
7. If you want to record your voice, check the audio mixer and confirm that the correct microphone input is available.
8. In the **Controls** panel, select **Start Recording**.
9. Record a short test, such as 10–15 seconds.
10. Select **Stop Recording**.

***Privacy check:*** *Close private messages, password managers, banking pages, and unrelated tabs before recording. Screen capture may include anything visible in the selected display or window.*

## 6. Find and review the recording

1. In OBS Studio, open **Settings**.
2. Find the **Output** section and locate the recording path or recording location setting. The exact tab and label can vary by version.
3. Open the configured folder in your file manager.
4. Open the newest recording with a media player.
5. Check that the video plays, the picture is correct, and the audio is present if you recorded audio.

### Success criteria

The setup is successful when:

- OBS Studio opens without an installation error.

- The preview shows the intended screen or window.
- The recording starts and stops when requested.
- The saved video opens and plays.
- The recording contains only the content you intended to capture.

## 7. Troubleshooting

| Problem | Possible cause | Quick fix |
|---|---|---|
| The installer will not open. | The download is incomplete, the operating system blocked it, or the installer does not match the system. | Download the installer again from the official OBS website and confirm you selected the correct operating system. Follow your operating system's security guidance. |
| The screen capture is blank. | The wrong source was selected, screen-recording permission is missing, or the application uses a protected surface. | Check the selected source and operating-system permissions. Re-select the intended display or window. |
| OBS does not capture the application window. | The wrong window is selected, or the application does not permit capture. | Re-select the correct window or use another supported capture source. Avoid capturing protected content. |
| No microphone audio is recorded. | The wrong input device is selected, the microphone is muted, or permission is denied. | Check the audio mixer, select the intended microphone, unmute it, and review system microphone permissions. |
| The recording file is difficult to find. | The configured recording folder is different from the expected folder. | Open OBS Settings, find the recording path under Output, and open that folder. |
| The recording stutters. | The computer is under load or the selected recording settings are too demanding. | Close unnecessary applications and try a shorter test with less demanding settings. |
| The recording contains private information. | Unrelated windows or notifications were visible during capture. | Stop the recording. Review the saved file before sharing it, and record again after closing or hiding private content. |

## 8. If the problem continues

Before asking for help, record:

- Your operating system and version.
- Your OBS Studio version.
- The capture source you selected.
- The steps that reproduce the issue.
- The exact error message, if one appears.

Share screenshots or logs only after checking that they do not contain private information.

## 9. Quick checklist

- [ ] Downloaded OBS Studio from the official website.
- [ ] Installed and opened the application.
- [ ] Selected a scene and capture source.
- [ ] Checked the preview and privacy.
- [ ] Made a short test recording.
- [ ] Opened and reviewed the saved file.

## 10. Scope and assumptions

This demo covers a basic local screen recording. It does not explain live streaming, advanced audio routing, plug-ins, virtual cameras, or professional production workflows. Verify the current OBS Studio interface and platform-specific permissions before publishing this guide as release-specific documentation.

**End of guide**